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AVATAR

THE LAST AIRBENDER™



NORTH AND SOUTH • PART THREE

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Created by

Bryan Konietzko

Michael Dante DiMartino



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script

GENE LUEN YANG

art and cover

GURIHIRU

lettering

MICHAEL HEISLER



DARK HORSE BOOKS

president and publisher
MIKE RICHARDSON

editor
DAVE MARSHALL

assistant editor
RACHEL ROBERTS

collection designer
SARAH TERRY

digital art technician
CHRISTIANNE GOUDREAU



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gloosh!





WE
SPECIALIZE IN THE
IMPOSSIBLE!

SO WHAT IF
WE'VE NEVER USED
METALBENDING LIKE
THIS BEFORE?!

WE
WEREN'T
SUPPOSED
TO BE ABLE TO
METALBEND
IN THE FIRST
PLACE!



COME
ON! ARE YOU
METALBENDERS
OR ARE YOU **LILY**
LIVERS?!

WELL...L...

HO TUN--!

METALBENDERS.

I GUESS.



BUT EVEN YOU GOTTA ADMIT, SIFU--
I MEAN, **EXECUTIVE PARTNER TOPH**,
CONSTRUCTING SOMETHING **THIS BIG**
IN THE MIDDLE OF ALL THIS **SNOW**,
WITHOUT ANY **WATERBENDERS**
AROUND TO HELP?

KINDA
CRAZY.



I KNOW,
I KNOW.

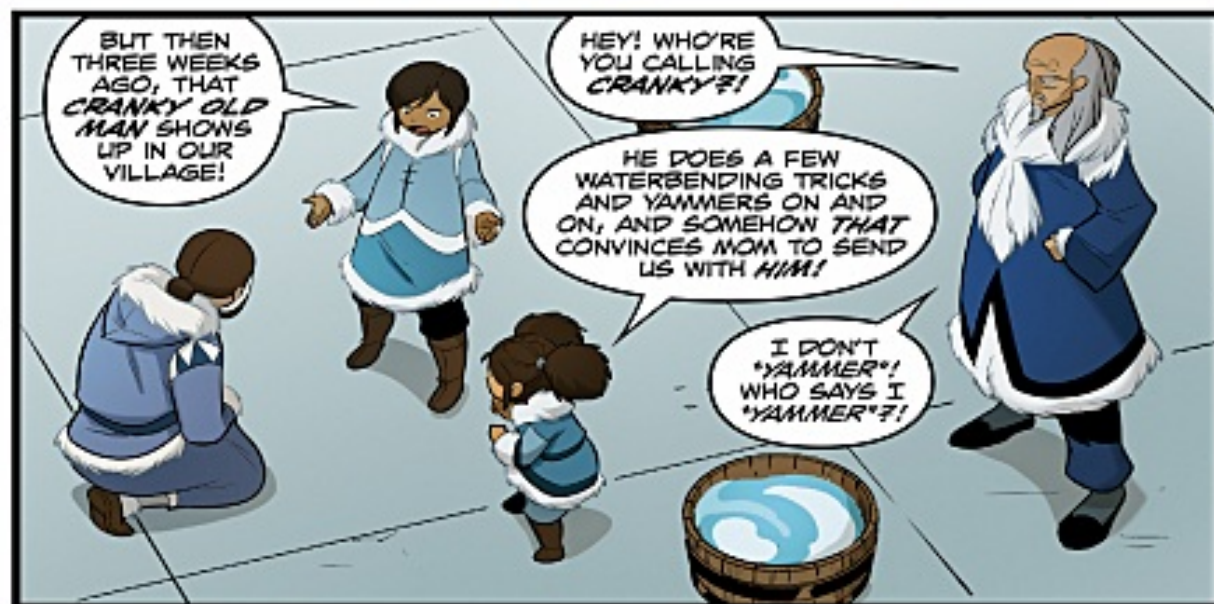
BUT THE ONLY **SOUTHERN WATER-**
BENDER IN THE WHOLE WORLD ISN'T
INTERESTED IN HELPING. AND FOR THE
TIME BEING, AT LEAST, WE CAN'T
HAVE ANY **NORTHERNERS**
WORKING HERE.

POLITICS
ARE DUMB,
BUT THEY'RE
STILL A PART OF
BUSINESS.

















**THE SOUTH FOR
SOUTHERNERS!**

**FOREIGNERS
OUT!**

ANNOUNCING
THE ARRIVAL OF
EARTH KING KUE!
AND FIRE LORD
ZUKO!

WE'RE HERE!
WE'RE FINALLY
HERE!

I'VE
BEEN WANTING
TO VISIT THE **SOUTH
POLE** FOR YEARS NOW,
EVER SINCE MEETING
KATARA AND SOKKA!
ISN'T THAT RIGHT,
BOSCO?

MY
GOODNESS!
IT'S EVERYTHING
I'D IMAGINED
IT'D BE! IT'S...
IT'S --

RAAAR!

--F-F-FREEZING!

WELL, IT IS
THE **SOUTH
POLE**, YOUR
MAJESTY.

ARE THOSE
P-P-PEOPLE
PROTESTING THE
C-C-COLD?

I'M AFRAID NOT. THEY'RE
PROTESTING **US**.

AND
AFTER WHAT THE
FIRE NATION HAS
PUT THEM THROUGH,
I CAN'T BLAME
THEM.

**BOO!
FOREIGNERS
OUT!**

BOSCO?
W-W-WOULD
YOU MIND?

RAAAR.

AAAH! MUCH BETTER!
EVERYONE SHOULD HAVE
A BEAR FOR A **BEST
FRIEND!**

ZUKO, IF YOU'D
LIKE TO JOIN ME,
I'M SURE THERE'S
ENOUGH ROOM IN
BOSCO'S HUG.

THAT'S
VERY, UM,
GENEROUS OF
YOU, BUT NO
THANKS.

FIRE
LORD ZUKO!
EARTH KING
KUE!





OFFICER, I HEARD A RUMOR THAT HAKODA INVITED **FOREIGNERS** FROM THE EARTH KINGDOM AND THE FIRE NATION INTO OUR HOMELAND FOR SOME SORT OF **CONFERENCE**.

IS THIS TRUE?

THEY ARRIVED ABOUT AN HOUR AGO.

HM.



WERE YOU AT THE FESTIVAL? DID YOU HEAR MY MESSAGE?

YES.

THEN YOU HEARD THE **EVIDENCE**. YOU KNOW HAKODA'S A **TRAITOR**. HOW CAN YOU CONTINUE TO SERVE IN HIS GOVERNMENT?



BECAUSE YOU'RE **WRONG**. HAKODA ISN'T A **TRAITOR**.

HE HAS A VISION FOR THE **FUTURE**.

AND WHAT IF THE CHOICE WERE BETWEEN THE **SOUTH** AND HAKODA'S SO-CALLED "**FUTURE**"? WHICH WOULD YOU CHOOSE?

I BELIEVE WE CAN HAVE **BOTH**.



WRONG
ANSWER.

?!

HOW--?!

GFF!

WHAM!



...A **MODERNIZED HARBOR** WOULD NOT ONLY GIVE THE **WORLD** ACCESS TO OUR **TRIBE**, BUT ALSO OUR **TRIBE** ACCESS TO THE **WORLD**.

AND FINALLY, WE WOULD LIKE TO ESTABLISH **EMBASSIES** IN BOTH OF YOUR NATIONS. WE, OF COURSE, INVITE YOU TO DO THE SAME.

AND THAT, MY FRIENDS, IS OUR **VISION** FOR THE FUTURE OF THE **SOUTHERN WATER TRIBE**.

HERE, HERE! HERE, HERE!

CLAP!
CLAP!

SIT DOWN, SOKKA! DIDN'T YOU SAY YOU WEREN'T A BIG FAN OF MEETINGS?!

NORMALLY, NO. BUT THIS ONE'S BEEN **AMAZING!**

I DON'T SEE WHAT'S SO AMAZING ABOUT CHANGING EVERYTHING WE'VE **EVER LOVED** ABOUT HOME!

AS I'M SURE YOU CAN IMAGINE, THE **SOUTHERN WATER TRIBE'S** ECONOMY HAS BEEN -- HOW SHOULD I PUT THIS? -- UNDER **EXTREME DURESS** FOR THE LAST CENTURY.

WE DON'T HAVE THE **PROPER RESOURCES** TO MAKE THIS VISION A REALITY.

AND THAT'S WHY WE'RE ASKING FOR YOUR **PARTNERSHIP**.

YOU CAN COUNT THE **FIRE NATION** IN, HEAD CHIEFTAIN HAKODA.

YOUR PEOPLE HAVE SUFFERED SO MUCH **DESTRUCTION** AT OUR HANDS.

WE ARE **GRATEFUL** FOR THE OPPORTUNITY TO HELP YOU **REBUILD**.

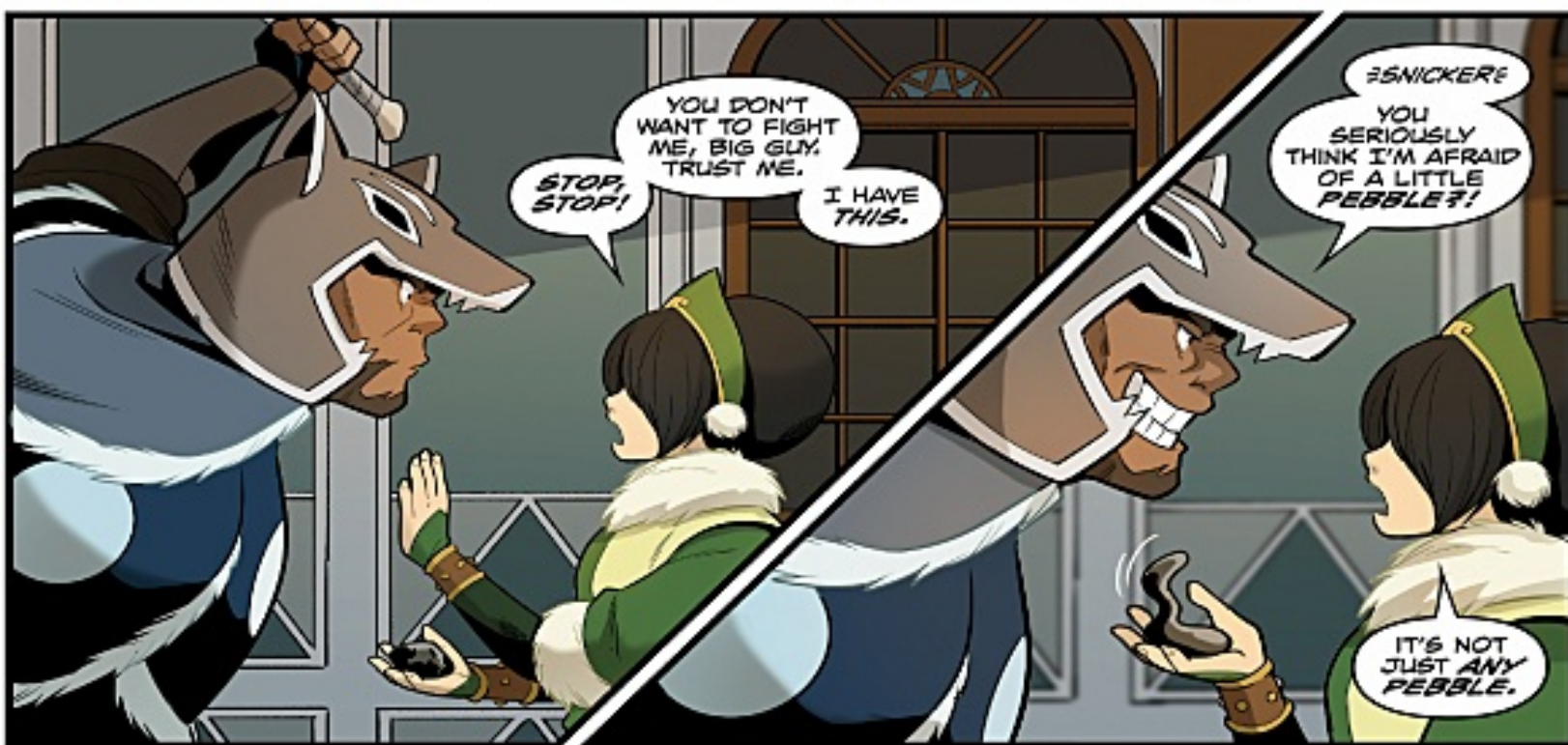






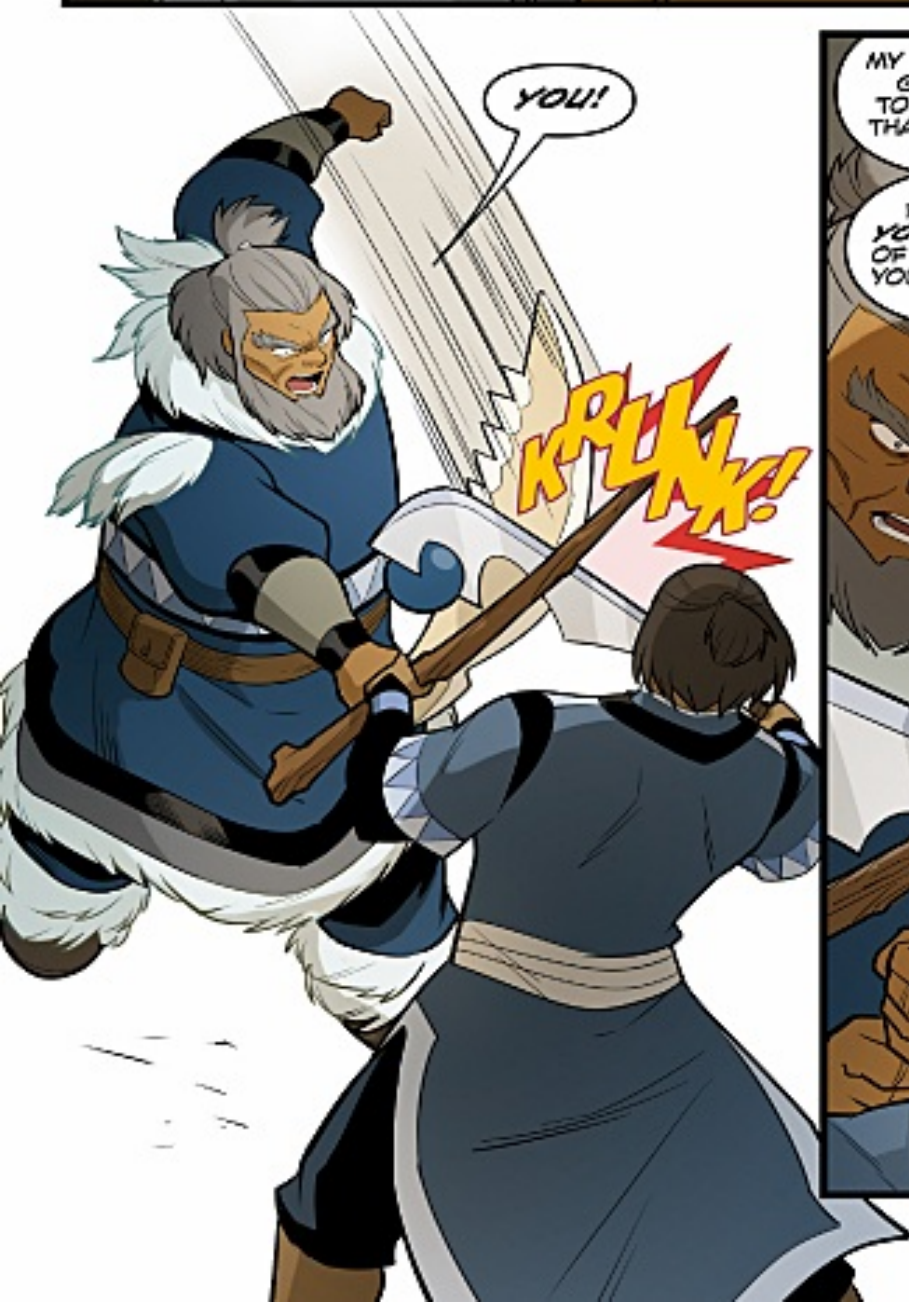




















DROP
ME HERE!

WHAT--?

HWOOSH!



STOMP!















"HE'LL SEND THOD
AND A COUPLE OF
HIS DISCIPLES OVER."

"WE HAVE TO
WILLINGLY ALLOW
THEM TO *CHI*
BLOCK ALL OF
OUR BENDERS."

WHAT?!

MAKES
SENSE. THEY
KNOW WE CAN EASILY
OVERPOWER THEM
OTHERWISE. THEY'RE
ESSENTIALLY ASKING
US TO LAY DOWN OUR
WEAPONS.

"THEN, AS SOON
AS DAD STARTS
ACROSS, GILAK
WILL SEND EARTH
KING KUEI OVER."

ANY FUNNY
BUSINESS, AND
GILAK CUTS THE
BRIDGE.

YOU
KNOW HE'S GOING
TO CUT THE BRIDGE
NO MATTER WHAT,
RIGHT? EVEN IF WE
GIVE IN TO ALL OF
HIS DEMANDS.

NO
WAY GILAK'S
GOING TO PASS UP
THE OPPORTUNITY TO
GET RID OF *TWO* OF
HIS ENEMIES AT
ONCE.



THE
BRIDGE
OF NO
RETURN.

EVERYTHING
IN PLACE?

ALL
ACCORDING TO
PLAN, PLANNER
GUY!

DON'T WORRY,
SWEETIE. SOKKA'S
PLAN IS PERFECT!
EVERYTHING'S GONNA
WORK OUT JUST
FINE!

Smek

I KNOW
IT WILL,
SWEETIE.

SIS...
YOU
OKAY?

THIS
ISN'T HOW I
IMAGINED OUR
TRIP BACK
HOME.

I ALWAYS
ASSUMED THAT ONCE
WE DEFEATED FIRE LORD
OZAI, THE *SOUTH POLE*
WOULD GO BACK TO THE
WAY IT WAS SUPPOSED
TO BE.

OUR
LIVES WOULD
GO BACK TO
THE WAY THEY'RE
SUPPOSED TO
BE.















WHAT--?!

BOOM



THAT'S NO WAY TO TREAT YOUR HEAD CHIEFTAIN, GILAK!

MALINA!

I'M A BUILDER, NOT A FIGHTER, SO I DON'T REALLY KNOW HOW TO USE MY BENDING FOR COMBAT.



GOOD THING MY FRIENDS HERE DO.



WHO ARE YOU?

REVEALING TO YOU THE EPHEMERAL LABELS LAID UPON US BY OUR FAMILIES-- MAY, BY SOCIETY ITSELF! -- WOULD BE FOR NAUGHT!

THEY'D BE RATTLED AWAY BY THE IMPENDING BATTLE, LIKE SO MANY MARBLES IN AN OPEN HAND!



HUH?



WHAT THE DARK ONE'S TRYING TO SAY IS, WE'D TELL YOU OUR NAMES, BUT WHAT'S THE POINT?

WE'RE ABOUT TO BEAT YOU *SENSELESS*, SO YOU'LL PROBABLY FORGET!



?! KROOM!

?! KROOM!

KRRASSSHHH!



MALINA AND THE METALBENDERS HAVE COME OUT OF HIDING!

OUR TURN!

WHAT IS THIS TRICKERY?!

I THINK YOU SHOULD APOLOGIZE TO MY FRIEND FOR CALLING HIM AN **ASH MAKER**.

IT'S NOT POLITE TO USE SLURS LIKE THAT, YOU KNOW?

KRCH!

WHAT'D YOU **DUNDERHEADS** SAY THIS WAS?

?!

I REMEMBER, TOPH!

PAYBACK.

KRCH!

HOW--?!

CHECK OUT THIS **CHAIN MAIL ARMOR**. PRETTY SLICK, RIGHT?

DESIGNED BY ME AND MADE BY THE STUDENTS OF THE **BEIFONG METALBENDING ACADEMY!**



TAKE
A COLD, HARD
LOOK AT YOURSELF,
GILAK. YOUR ENTIRE
ARMY'S BEEN TAKEN
DOWN.

SURRENDER
AND I'LL ASK
THE HEAD CHIEFTAIN
TO GIVE YOU MORE
MERCY THAN YOU
DESERVE!

TO SCUM
LIKE YOU?
NEVER!

FOR
THE
TRIBE!



















-- YOU
WON'T --

-- WILLIN!

I...
TOLD YOU
GUYS... NOT
TO MOVE SO
MUCH!

I'M
LOSING... MY
GRIP!







GO ON,
SIS. SAY WHAT
YOU NEED TO
SAY.

...

YOU KNOW, WHEN SOKKA
AND I FINALLY CAME BACK,
I WAS HOPING TO FIND A
HOME WHERE EVERYTHING'S
HOW IT'S *SUPPOSED*
TO BE.

BUT I
REALIZE NOW, THAT
JUST ISN'T *POSSIBLE*.
BECAUSE A HOME WHERE
EVERYTHING'S HOW
IT'S SUPPOSED TO
BE --

-- IS
A HOME WITH
YOU STILL IN
IT, MOM.

YESTERDAY, I
HAD TO SAVE THIS
WOMAN NAMED
MALINA.

YOU'VE
NEVER MET HER.
SHE'S DIFFERENT
FROM YOU -- *REALLY*
DIFFERENT -- BUT I
HAVE A FEELING YOU
WOULD'VE *LIKED*
HER.

WHEN I
SAVED HER, I
FELT A *COURAGE*
DEEP INSIDE, A
FAMILIAR SORT
OF COURAGE.

I'D FELT IT
BEFORE WHEN I
FOUGHT *AZULA*. AND
WHEN I SAVED *AANG* AS
WE LEFT THE CRYSTAL
CATACOMBS. AND WHEN
ADMIRAL ZHAO KILLED
THE MOON SPIRIT AND
WE HAD TO BRING
IT BACK.



THAT WAS *YOUR* COURAGE, MOM. THE COURAGE YOU PASSED ON TO ME.



THINGS ARE STILL CHANGING HERE.

I HAVEN'T YET CONVINCED DAD AND MALINA TO NOT BUILD THAT OIL REFINERY.

AND THE PROTESTERS HAVEN'T GONE AWAY.



BUT THROUGH IT ALL, I DON'T HAVE TO KEEP HOPING FOR WHAT'S "SUPPOSED TO BE"...

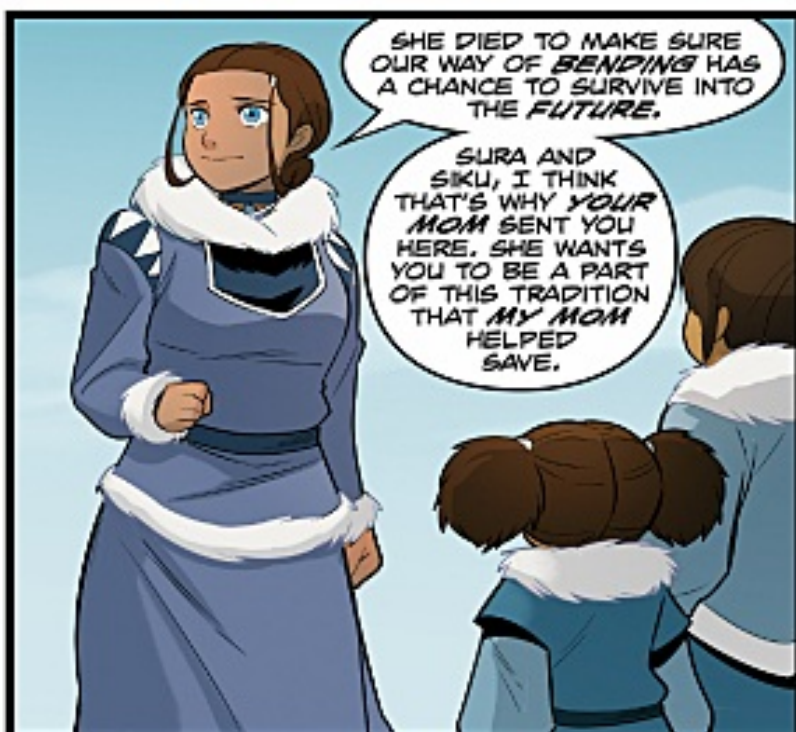
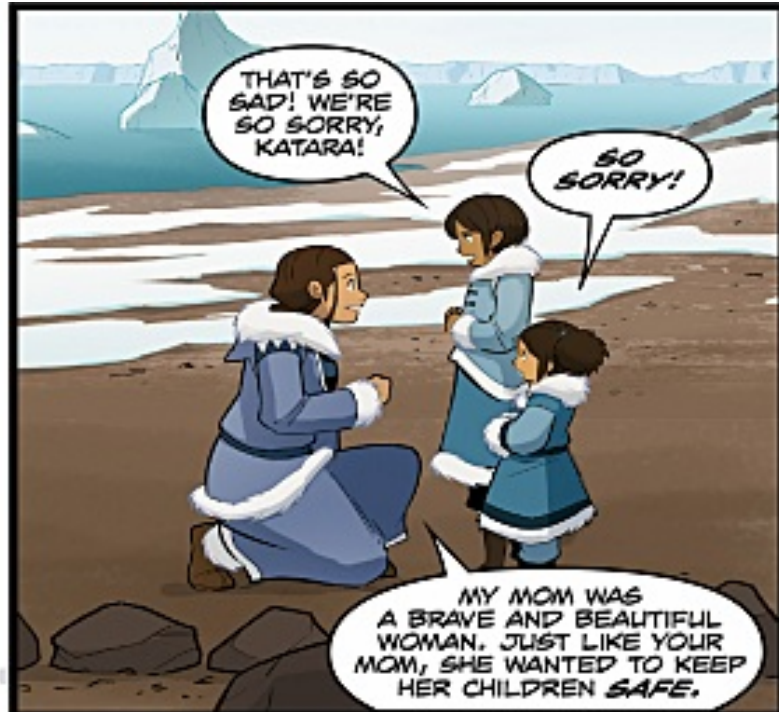
...BECAUSE YOU'VE BEEN WITH ME ALL ALONG.



GUYS, COME OVER!

YOU SURE? WE DON'T WANT TO INTRUDE.

YOU'RE NOT INTRUDING!











THE END





North versus South—the final showdown!

Fire Lord Zuko and Earth King Kuei arrive in the lands of the Southern Water Tribe amid protests against Gilak's imprisonment. While the leaders hold council to solidify Malina and Hakoda's unification plans, Gilak breaks free and leads a powerful rebellion, crashing the council and kidnapping the Earth King! In the face of these two opposing forces, Katara will have to make peace with her nostalgia and distrust to save the home and family she loves from being permanently torn apart.

Written and drawn by Gene Luen Yang and Gurihiru, the creative team behind the best-selling *The Search*, *The Rift*, and *Smoke and Shadow*, in collaboration with *Avatar: The Last Airbender* and *Legend of Korra* creators Michael Dante DiMartino and Bryan Konietzko, this is the ultimate continuation of *Avatar* and the perfect companion to *Legend of Korra*!

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